



HUMANITAS  
INSTITUTE

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Baldwin Christian School  
School Website: <https://baldwinchristianschool.org/>

January 7, 2026

**Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

### Classicality Audit Report: Baldwin Christian School

Website audited: <https://www.baldwinchristianschool.org/>

#### Executive Summary

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
- Why: Baldwin Christian School (BCS) explicitly anchors its mission and curriculum in Christian theology, the transcendental ideals of truth, goodness, and beauty, and the liberal arts tradition (Trivium; Great Books), with age-appropriate pedagogy (chanting, memory work; Socratic discussion; thesis defense) and clear parent partnership language. Evidence appears consistently across admissions, academics, and program pages, and aligns closely with the Six Essential Elements positive indicator lexicon.
- Notable strengths: Robust Trivium framing; Great Books lists; Latin and Greek; explicit Socratic discussions; liturgical elements (Bible, prayer, hymns; choir); explicit parent partnership.
- Opportunities: Faculty section could strengthen by publishing an explicit portrait of a teacher, stated mentor/collegial formation practices, or faculty classical formation. (Indicator rationale per the Six Elements faculty lexicon.)

Method note: This audit follows the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School keyword framework (positive/negative indicators), applying it to the school's public materials. The element-by-element keyword lists and criteria are taken from the provided "Six Essential Elements" materials and supporting lexicon.

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#### Six-Element Keyword Analysis and Ratings

##### CATEGORY 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations

- School keywords found (from BCS pages):
- Transcendentals and virtues: "truth, beauty, and goodness"; "mature character"; "whole person made in the image of God."
- Theological grounding: "Christ-centered"; "acknowledges Christ ruling over all things"; "Bible."
- Liturgical/communal: "prayer, Bible stories, memory verses, songs, and hymns in daily activities"; choir.
- Comparison to Six Elements positive/negative indicators:
- Positive matches: truth/goodness/beauty; virtue; theology/Christian worldview; Bible/scripture; prayer/hymnody/choir; "image of God" (imago Dei) align directly with the Religious & Metaphysical Foundations positive list.

- Negative matches: none observed (e.g., no “values-neutral,” “moral relativism,” or “religiously neutral” language).
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: 8 (truth, beauty, goodness; virtue/character; Christ-centered; Christ ruling over all; Bible; prayer; hymns/choir; image of God)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage estimate: 100% (all three sub-areas—moral realism, theology, liturgical life—present)
- Rating: CLASSICAL

#### CATEGORY 2: School Purpose and Goal

- School keywords found:
- Aim: “classically educate... to dedicate their lives to God... for the sake of Christ”; “pursue truth, beauty, and goodness”; “classical Christian education is a lifelong process... tools of learning... Great Conversation.”
- Formation: “intentional about educating the whole person... made in the image of God”; “mature students in Christ”; “mature character.”
- Comparison to indicators:
- Positive matches: cultivation of wisdom/virtue; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; formation not mere information; Great Conversation; tools of learning.
- Negative matches: none (no “college and career readiness”/“21st-century skills” emphasis).
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: 7 (truth/goodness/beauty; formation/whole person; Great Conversation; tools of learning; Christ-oriented telos; mature character; lifelong process)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage estimate: 100%
- Rating: CLASSICAL

#### CATEGORY 3: Curriculum

- School keywords found:
- Liberal Arts/Trivium: “Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric)” with K–12 stage descriptions.
- Great Books: explicit reading list (Odyssey; Plutarch; Socrates; Gilgamesh; Hammurabi; Lewis; Adler’s How to Read a Book).
- Classical languages: Latin (logic stage), Koine Greek (rhetoric students).
- Integration: “Integrating Subjects” articulated.
- Music/fine arts: choir/ensemble, music study.
- Comparison to indicators:
- Positive matches: trivium; Great Books/primary sources; Latin/Greek; integrated/harmonious curriculum; fine arts.
- Negative matches: none (no “social studies” replacing history; no STEM-first/project-based dominance).
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: 12 (trivium terms x3; Great Books; list of classics; Latin; Greek; integration; music/choir; Western heritage; Socratic ties; rhetoric thesis)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage estimate: 100%
- Rating: CLASSICAL

#### CATEGORY 4: Pedagogy (Teaching Methods)

- School keywords found:
- Grammar years: “memorize... chants, songs, rhythmic verse”; memory verses (Pre-K).
- Logic/upper years: “Socratic Discussion”; “debate”; “asking guiding questions” to form reasoning.

- Rhetoric: “presents and defends a thesis... Socratic discussion.”
- Comparison to indicators:
- Positive matches: chanting/singing/memorization; Socratic dialogue; debate/disputation; rhetoric and thesis/oration.
- “Restful learning/scholé”: not explicitly stated on-site; however, overall contemplative/formation notes are strong.
- Negative matches: none of the project-only/constructivist dominance signals.
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: 6 (memorization/chant; Pre-K hymns; Socratic; debate; guiding questions; thesis defense)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage estimate: 85% (all but explicit “scholé”)
- Rating: CLASSICAL

#### CATEGORY 5: Faculty

- School keywords found:
- “Teachers are mission minded and called to equip and help mold the next generation of Christian leaders.”
- “Dedicated teachers love their subjects and their students, [educating] the whole person... in the image of God.”
- Comparison to indicators:
- Positive matches: teachers as models/mentors; virtue formation; love of subject; responsibility. (Faculty element emphasizes “models of virtue” and “mentorship/collegiality.”)
- Missing/less explicit: formal “portrait of a teacher,” explicit faculty collegium/formation rhythms.
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: 4 (mission-minded; modeling formation; love of students/subjects; whole-person formation)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage estimate: 65% (virtue-modeling evident; mentorship/collegial infrastructure not as explicit publicly)
- Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

#### CATEGORY 6: Parents & Community

- School keywords found:
- “Education is a partnership with parents.” (Admissions)
- Open hospitality: tours; family interview with headmaster; “get to know more about us.”
- Formation language in community-facing pages: “pursue truth, beauty, and goodness.”
- Comparison to indicators:
- Positive matches: partnership with parents; open campus/tours; communication of classical philosophy.
- Missing/less explicit: formal parent formation/book studies on-site (may exist offline).
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: 4 (partnership; tours; interview; TB&G community ethos)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage estimate: 75% (parent formation programming not explicit)
- Rating: CLASSICAL

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#### Aggregate Assessment

- Category ratings:

- Religious/Metaphysical: CLASSICAL
- Purpose & Goal: CLASSICAL
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy: CLASSICAL
- Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL
- Overall: CLASSICAL

The school's language strongly matches the positive indicators across the Six Elements framework (e.g., truth/goodness/beauty; Trivium; Great Books; Socratic; rhetoric thesis; prayer/hymns/choir; parent partnership) and shows no substantive negative-indicator language (e.g., "values-neutral," "career readiness" slogans, constructivist dominance).

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#### Detailed Evidence Highlights (select examples)

- Trivium and stages: explicit Grammar–Logic–Rhetoric descriptions.
- Great Books & classical canon (sample middle school list).
- Socratic discussion and debate methods.
- Senior thesis defense (rhetoric capstone).
- Latin and Koine Greek study.
- Liturgical practices: daily prayer, Bible, hymns; choir.
- Purpose/formation language: truth, beauty, goodness; whole-person formation; Great Conversation.
- Parent partnership language.

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#### Notes on Framework and Scoring

- Positive/negative indicators and definitions are drawn from "Six Essential Elements of a Classical School," including sub-criteria for each category (e.g., Trivium/Great Books; liturgy/chapel; Socratic/thesis; parent partnership).
  - Supplemental lexicon terms used to classify site language are from the provided classicality lexicon (e.g., trivium, quadrivium, great books, Socratic seminar, chapel/hymnody, parent partnership).
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## Appendix

### ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.